A Letter Expressing Support for Candidate LT Casey Cowan

November 10, 2026



Gentlemen of The Rittenhouse Club,

It is my privilege to recommend LT Casey Cowan for membership in The Rittenhouse Club. Casey is a man of quiet substance. He is reserved and observant, listens more than he talks, and notices what others need before they ask. I have known him only a short while, but it has taken just a few encounters to see that he is a man of character.

One moment captures him better than anything on his résumé. A few weeks ago I was trying to sort out how to navigate my own VR&E paperwork and mentioned it in passing to someone else. Casey overheard. That evening, unprompted, he sent me a set of resources he had put together, then sat down with me and walked through how he had handled the same thing himself. He did not make a show of it, and he did not wait to be asked. That instinct, to act for others without being asked and without needing credit, is the clearest measure of character I know, and it is who Casey is.

Casey grew up in Houston, where he was a two-time prep All-American and three-time All-State wrestler at The Kinkaid School. He went on to the United States Naval Academy, where he earned a degree in Systems Engineering, wrestled Division I for four years, and was named to the Commandant's List three times.

He was commissioned as a Navy SEAL Officer in 2018 and spent the next eight years in Naval Special Warfare: first as a squad commander, leading his men through training and a deployment to East Africa; then as a squadron assistant operations officer across multiple further deployments to the region; and finally in a NATO-facing role, leading a team responsible for partner engagements with European special operations commands. He remains a Navy reservist today.

Since leaving active duty, Casey has moved into business with the same intent. He served as a Venture Fellow at Context VC, a firm that backs military veteran founders, and completed Tuck's Next Step program at Dartmouth. He came to Wharton as a PIMCO Scholar and a Delaney Veteran Fellow. He also sits on the Service Academy Nomination Board for Virginia's Second Congressional District and has volunteered with the Travis Manion Foundation.

What sets Casey apart is not any one of these things but the way he holds them. He is humble about a career most men would lead with. He is the sort of man I would want to have around every day. He has the character, the judgment, and the generosity that this Club was built around, and he would strengthen our fellowship from the day he joined.

LT Cowan's candidacy is seconded by SSG Rothe and Mr. Jackson III.

In the Bonds,
Capt. Rafael Ramirez
Class of 2027

